

MPD server and the HTTP streaming server.

Scrobble Music to Last.fm

There are several ways to scrobble music played by MPD. Most MPD clients offer this feature, but our plugin of choice is called *mpdscribble*, which is a background process capable of sending data to both Last.fm and Libre.fm simultaneously. Install *mpdscribble* from the default repository for your distribution and edit the file `/etc/mpdscribble.conf` with your Last.fm login details. Next, activate the daemon by setting

```
MPD_SYSTEMWIDE=1
in the file /etc/default/
mpdscribble. Restart the service with
sudo service mpd-
scribble restart
and your music should now
be scrobbled flawlessly!
```

Playback music from Last.fm streams

MPD can also playback music from Last.fm streams, for which you'll need to edit your `~/mpd/mpd.conf` and add the following section to it:

```
playlist_plugin {
    name
    "lastfm"
    user
    "lastfm_username"
    password
    "lastfm_password"
}
```

To start the playback, use the following command:

```
mpc load "lastfm://
name/of/stream"
```

PHOTOSHOP

We had last covered Photoshop in this space when it's beta came out. Now that the Creative Suite 6 has been officially released, and the dust has settled, we're bringing together some of the best tips and tricks that we came across in some of

the more important software in the latest series of creative tools from Adobe.

Photoshop was designed well as a photo editor, but it now performs task above and beyond it's call of duty. Photoshop CS6 now provides improved 3D support, better handling of vector paths and even video. Here are a few of the more interesting tricks that you'll find useful if you use it day in day out.

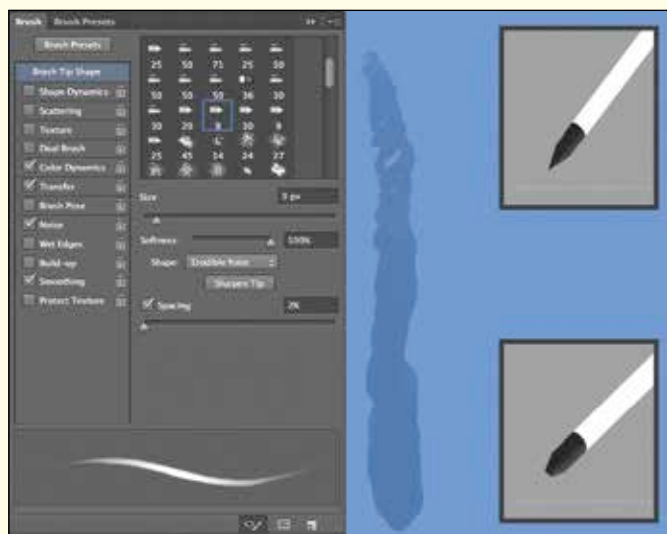
Erodible Brushes

A new addition to Photoshop CS6, an erodible brush lets you draw a line as if you would have done with a pencil or a crayon, i.e., it erodes away as you use it. Photoshop also offers air-brush tip shape which is designed to be used with a tablet to create thinner or thicker lines, depending on the pressure you apply when operating the tablet.

You can select an erodible brush from the brushes pull down menu. An erodible brush looks like a pencil. Once you select that brush a new window is seen which shows how worn-out or sharp the brush is. You can fine-tune the eroding properties in the brush panel which lets you select the brush type from the following: Erodible Point, Erodible Flat, Erodible Round, Erodible Square, Erodible Rectangle, Erodible Triangle and Custom. The softness of the brush determines how easily it will wear out, the higher the softness the faster will it wear out.

Type Styles

InDesign guys have been enjoying for quite some time now. Essentially, you can save the text formatting styles as style presets and then apply them to selected text and/or paragraphs in your file. This especially beneficial for the designers who use Photoshop to create website



Erodible Brushes in Photoshop CS6

mockups, this will help them by saving time and smoothing the production workflow.

You can bring up the Character Styles and Paragraph Styles Panel from the Type menu in the main menu bar. You can define the new style by selecting some text and making changes in either the Character Panel or the Paragraph Panel. Once you're done just hit the "New Style" button in either of the style panels and you're done.

Preset Migration and Sharing

If you have been working on Photoshop for some time you'll have collected and organised your own collection of presets and it can be one hell of a task shifting

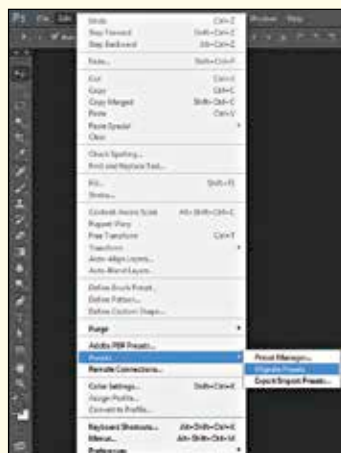
all of them to the new version. You can migrate your presets from the older version you have on your system by going to Edit > Presets > Migrate Presets. The Presets menu also provides an option to Import or Export your presets so that they can be saved or shared with your friends and co-workers.

Auto Recovery and Background Saving

How many times have you lost hours of work because you forgot to save the file? This will no longer be the problem with Photoshop CS6. It introduces two new features *Background Saving* and *Auto Recovery*. Background Save feature allows you to continue working while the save is in progress which was not possible in the earlier versions of Photoshop. This bumps up your productivity. You can also get Photoshop to keep saving your work incrementally by going to Edit > Preferences > File Handling and selecting the time interval after which to save.

Performance Enhancements

There is no denying that Photoshop is a resource hog, but you can tweak its innards to extract



Import presets from older versions